

Country PhD Intelligence: Canada

Academic Intelligence Dossier • 2026-09-23

Country Code: CA

Primary Currency: CAD

Execution Date: 2026-09-23

Target PhD Field: Edge Computing, Edge AI & Distributed Systems

1. Country Overview & Research Ecosystem

Canada offers an internationally renowned doctoral research ecosystem characterized by world-class university laboratories, competitive national and institutional funding structures, and clear pathways for international doctoral scholars.

* **Primary Funding Vehicle:** Vanier CGS (\$50,000/yr), NSERC Fellowships & Departmental Guaranteed PhD Funding Packages (\$25k-\$35k/yr)

* **Immigration & Dependant Policy:** Spouses/common-law partners of full-time doctoral (PhD) students are eligible for a Spousal Open Work Permit (SOWP); minor children can study at public schools without study permit.

* **Official Guidance:**
<https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/study-canada/work/help-your-spouse-work.html>

2. Executive Intelligence Metrics

* **Total Top Universities Identified:** 8

* **Total Vetted Professors Monitored:** 8

* **Available Doctoral Funding Schemes:** 2

* **Key Application Deadline:** 2026-12-15

3. Discovered Universities & Suitability

University	Relevant Departments	Research Suitability	Funding Rating	Official Portal
University of Waterloo	David R. Cheriton School of Computer Science, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering	62.5%	High	Portal
University of Toronto	Department of Computer Science, The Edward S. Rogers Sr. Department of Electrical & Computer Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal
University of British Columbia	Department of Computer Science, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal
McGill University	School of Computer Science, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal

University of Alberta	Department of Computing Science, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal
Simon Fraser University	School of Computing Science, School of Engineering Science	59.5%	High	Portal
Queen's University	School of Computing, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal
McMaster University	Department of Computing and Software, Department of Electrical & Computer Engineering	59.5%	High	Portal

4. Top Vetted PhD Supervisors & Relevance

Professor	University	Priority Tier	Research Fit	Recruitment Status	Profile Link
Prof. Jiangchuan Liu	Simon Fraser University	Tier 1	100.0%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Raouf Boutaba	University of Waterloo	Tier 1	97.0%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Karthik Pattabiraman	University of British Columbia	Tier 1	95.8%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Di Niu	University of Alberta	Tier 1	94.8%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Sathish Gopalakrishnan	University of British Columbia	Tier 1	92.8%	STRONG_EVIDENCE	Dossier
Prof. Yashar Ganjali	University of Toronto	Tier 1	71.0%	CONFIRMED_ACTIVE	Dossier
Prof. Cristiana Amza	University of Toronto	Tier 1	68.2%	STRONG_EVIDENCE	Dossier
Prof. Muthucumaru Maheswaran	McGill University	Tier 2	75.0%	STRONG_EVIDENCE	Dossier

5. Major Doctoral Funding Schemes & Scholarships

Vanier Canada Graduate Scholarships (Vanier CGS)

* **Provider / University:** Government of Canada (CIHR, NSERC, SSHRC) (All Participating Canadian Institutions (Toronto, Waterloo, UBC, McGill, Alberta, etc.))

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full tuition waivers typically awarded alongside fellowship by host institution

* **Stipend / Salary:** CAD \$50,000/year tax-free stipend + Spousal Open Work Permit (SOWP) eligibility

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** GOOD

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-11-01

* **Official Source:** <https://vanier.gc.ca/en/home-accueil.html>

Guaranteed Minimum Doctoral Funding Package (Research & Teaching Assistantships)

* **Provider / University:** University Graduate Studies & Faculty Research Grants (NSERC Discovery Grants) (Canadian Research Universities (Toronto, Waterloo, UBC, McGill))

* **Funding Type:** FULLY_FUNDED

* **Tuition Coverage:** Full international tuition differential fee waiver or reimbursement

* **Stipend / Salary:** CAD \$25,000 - \$35,000/year base living funding (after tuition is covered)

* **International Eligibility:** ELIGIBLE

* **Dependant Support:** GOOD

* **Application Deadline:** 2026-12-15

* **Official Source:** <https://web.cs.toronto.edu/graduate/funding>

6. Strategic Application Timeline & Next Steps

1. **Weeks 1–4:** Review individual 33-section professor dossiers under `professors`.

2. **Weeks 5–6:** Conduct tailored email outreach referencing recent publications and active laboratory grants.

3. **Weeks 7–8:** Formalize 5-page research proposal aligned with the supervisor's documented testbeds.

4. **Target Deadline:** Submit institutional application ahead of **2026-12-15**.

Report compiled automatically by the Global Country-Based PhD Funding and Supervisor Intelligence Engine on 2026-09-23.